

Chapter 1: Introduction

Manuals and benefit plans referenced in this guide

Some benefit plans included under your Agreement may be subject to requirements found in other health care provider guides or manuals or to the supplements found in the second half of this guide.

This section provides information about some of the most common UnitedHealthcare products. Your Agreement may use “benefit contract types,” “benefit plan types” or a similar term to refer to our products.



Visit UHCprovider.com/plans for more information about our products and Individual Exchange benefit plans offered by state.

If a member presents a health plan ID card with a product name you are not familiar with, go to UHCprovider.com > Sign In > Eligibility to quickly find information on the plan. You can also connect with us [via chat](#) 24/7 from the UnitedHealthcare Provider Portal. For additional contact information, visit UHCprovider.com/contactus.

You are subject to the provisions of additional guides when providing covered services to a member of those benefit plans, as described in your Agreement and in the following table. We may make changes to health care provider guides, supplements and manuals that relate to protocol and payment policy changes.

We may change the location of a website, a benefit plan name, branding or the health plan ID card. We inform you of those changes through one of our health care provider communications resources.

Benefit plans subject to this guide

Plan name	Location of most members subject to additional guides	Location of plan information
Empire Plan	All markets outside of NY* and national health care providers; primary concentrations in: AZ, CA, CT, DE, FL, GA, MA, MD, NC, NJ, NV, PA, SC, TN, TX, VA ID cards are produced and distributed by The Empire Plan customer. Please see Empire Plan supplement for card samples.	Empire Plan supplement to this guide
Exchanges	AL, AZ, FL, GA, IA, IL, IN, KS, LA, MD, MI, MO, MS, NC, NE, NJ, NM, OH, OK, SC, TN, TX, VA, WA, WI, WY	Chapter 4: Individual Exchange plans to this guide
Medicare Advantage (including Dual Special Needs Plans)	Multiple states	Chapter 5: Medicare products to this guide

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Plan name	Location of most members subject to additional guides	Location of plan information
MDIPA: MD Individual Practice Association, Inc.	DC, DE, MD, VA, WV Some counties in: Southeastern PA	Mid-Atlantic Regional supplement to this guide
Capitated and/or Delegated Providers (commercial and Medicare Advantage)	All markets	Capitation and/or delegation supplement to this guide
NHP: Neighborhood Health Partnership, Inc.	FL	Neighborhood Health Partnership supplement to this guide
OCI: Optimum Choice Inc.	DC, DE, MD, VA, WV Some counties in: PA	Mid-Atlantic Regional supplement to this guide
OneNet PPO	DC, DE, FL, GA, MD, NC, PA, SC, TN, VA, WV	OneNet PPO supplement to this guide
Oxford: • Oxford Health Plans, LLC • Oxford Health Insurance, Inc. • Investors Guaranty Life Insurance Company, Inc. • Oxford Health Plans (NY), Inc. • Oxford Health Plans (NJ), Inc. • Oxford Health Plans (CT), Inc. • Oxford Level Funded Plans (NJ, CT)	CT, NJ, NY (except upstate) Some counties in: PA	Oxford commercial supplement to this guide
Peoples Health	LA	Peoples Health supplement to this guide
Preferred Care Network	FL counties: Broward and Miami-Dade	Preferred Care Network supplement to this guide
Preferred Care Partners	FL counties: Broward, Miami-Dade and Palm Beach	Preferred Care Partners supplement to this guide

Plan name	Location of most members subject to additional guides	Location of plan information
River Valley: - UnitedHealthcare Services Company of the River Valley, Inc. - UnitedHealthcare Plan of the River Valley, Inc. - UnitedHealthcare Insurance Company of the River Valley	Parts of AR, GA, IA, IL, TN, VA, WI Your UnitedHealthcare contract specifically references River Valley or John Deere Health protocols or guides; and You are located in AR, GA, IA, TN, VA, WI or these counties in Illinois: Jo Daviess, Stephenson, Carroll, Ogle, Mercer, Whiteside, Lee, Rock Island, Henry, Bureau, Putnam, Henderson, Warren, Knox, Stark, Marshall, Livingston, Hancock, McDonough, Fulton, Peoria, Tazewell, Woodford, McLean; and You are providing services to a River Valley Commercial member and not a River Valley Medicare Advantage, Medicaid or CHIP member. Note: River Valley also offers benefit plans in LA, NC, OH and SC, but the River Valley Additional Guide does not apply to those benefit plans.	River Valley entities supplement to this guide
Sierra or Health Plan of Nevada: - Sierra Health and Life Insurance Co., Inc. - Health Plan of Nevada, Inc. - Sierra Healthcare Options, Inc.	Outside NV only: The health plan ID card identifies the Sierra or Health Plan of Nevada members who access the UnitedHealthcare network outside of Nevada, and includes the following reference: UnitedHealthcare Choice Plus Network Outside Nevada	Services rendered outside of Nevada to Sierra or Health Plan of Nevada members with the ID card reference described in this row are subject to your UnitedHealthcare Agreement and to this guide unless you are in Arizona or Utah and have a contract directly with Sierra or Health Plan of Nevada
UMR and UHSS: - UMR - UnitedHealthcare Shared Services (UHSS)	All markets	UMR and UHSS supplement to this guide umar.com
UnitedHealthcare Level Funded	All markets	UnitedHealthcare Level Funded supplement to this guide

Plan name	Location of most members subject to additional guides	Location of plan information
UnitedHealthcare West: (formerly referenced in this guide as PacifiCare) UHC of California DBA UnitedHealthcare of California (hereinafter referred to as UnitedHealthcare of California)	CA	UnitedHealthcare West supplement to this guide
UnitedHealthOne: - Golden Rule Insurance Company Group #705214 - Oxford Health Insurance, Inc. Group #908410	All markets New Jersey	UnitedHealthOne Individual Plans supplement to this guide UHCprovider.com and myuhone.com
UnitedHealthcare Freedom Plans	NH, ME, VT	UHCprovider.com
UnitedHealthcare Student Resources	All states	Student Resources supplement to this guide uhcsr.com and UHCprovider.com
USHEALTH Group		USHEALTH Group Individual and Association Group supplement to this guide
UHC Complete Individual		UHC Complete Individual supplement to this guide

* PacifiCare of Arizona is now referenced as UnitedHealthcare Benefits of Texas, Inc.

Benefit plans not subject to this guide

Plan name	Location of most members subject to additional guides	Additional guide/website
Rocky Mountain Health Plan (RMHP)	CO	Rocky Mountain Provider Manual Rocky Mountain Behavioral Health Provider Manual
Sierra: Sierra Health and Life Insurance Co., Inc. Sierra Healthcare Options, Inc. Health Plan of Nevada, Inc. Health Plan of Nevada Medicaid/ Nevada Check Up	NV	Benefit plans for Sierra Health and Life Insurance Company, Inc.: sierrahealthandlife.com/provider Benefit plans for Sierra Healthcare Options, Inc.: sierrahealthcareoptions.com Benefit plans for Health Plan of Nevada, Inc.: healthplanofnevada.com/provider myhpnmedicaid.com/provider
UnitedHealthcare Community Plan Medicaid, CHIP and Uninsured	Multiple states	UnitedHealthcare Community Plan Care Provider Manuals for Medicaid (by state) UHCprovider.com/guides > Find Your State

Obligation to do business with UnitedHealthcare electronically

Going digital is fast and efficient, and supports a paperless work environment. This means, where allowed by law, UnitedHealthcare requires you to use digital tools where available when conducting business with UnitedHealthcare. This includes submissions and inquiries related to claims, reconsiderations and appeals, prior authorization and electronic delivery of claim-related documents.

The benefits of going digital

Our digital tools offer a more direct path to the information you need. This means:

- **24/7 access** – Our website, portal and chat windows never close
- **Complete common and complex tasks quicker** – Self-serve first for everyday tasks. This includes:
 - Completing and tracking credentialing requests in real time with Onboard Pro
 - Viewing claim status
 - Verifying benefits and eligibility
 - Submitting prior authorizations
 - Viewing ID cards
 - Verifying and attesting to your demographic data accuracy
- **Reliable routing, faster decisions and better documentation** – Online requests and submissions are routed to the right people, right away – all with a digital trail. This includes:
 - Prior authorizations
 - Reconsiderations
 - Pre- and post-service appeals

